

# SOLID STATE

## Talent Bible - Version 1.0

Frozen core talent design for the first playable. Creative source of truth; machine-facing fields are mirrored in the Talent Registry.

### 1. Core rule

Talents are a primary source of replayability. Species describes what society expects from the protagonist; talents describe what is unusual about this incarnation. The first playable contains 30 talents, with a long-term target of roughly 200-300.

### 2. Player agency

After the player selects three talents and allocates starting attributes, the life simulator runs automatically. There are no mid-life dialogue, treatment, legal, route, or ending choices. A route is an emergent internal event chain; a branch is an automatically selected conditional outcome.

### 3. Event-driven attribute drift

Events are the primary source of attribute change after age 18. Events may modify CHR, INT, STR, MNY, SPR, and FIX. For the first slice, at least 45% of authored random events should modify one or more visible attributes, and at least 15% should modify two or more. This is mandatory so threshold talents can activate during life rather than only during setup.

### 4. One-shot threshold triggers

A threshold talent remains dormant until its condition is satisfied. At the end of each resolved event chain, dormant threshold talents are checked. Newly triggered effects are permanent, are never revoked if the condition later becomes false, and may trigger other dormant talents. Evaluation repeats until stable. Because each threshold talent fires only once, the cascade terminates.

### 5. Trigger checkpoints

Check after starting allocation/species effects, after unconditional start talents, after every completed event chain, and after any exceptional system operation that directly modifies attributes. A threshold crossed inside a chain does not retroactively alter a branch within that same chain.

### 6. Attribute modifier philosophy

Talent effects are not limited to +/-1. Common and Uncommon talents may use larger values, mixed bonuses/penalties, and threshold bonuses. Legendary and Anomalous talents often have no direct stat modifier because their structural effects are already powerful. Flavor may be ironic, but explicit mechanics must never lie.

### 7. Rarity

Common = small trait or blunt mechanic; Uncommon = upbringing/profession/institution interaction; Rare = significant route or survival influence; Legendary = a social/physical rule works differently; Anomalous = a world assumption becomes unreliable. Rarity measures unusual influence, not benefit.

### 8. Incompatibilities

Initial pairs: Keeps a Low Profile vs Main Character Syndrome; Unregistered Species vs Wrong Species Certificate; Object Permanence vs Soul Cannot Harden. They may appear together in a draft, but selecting one disables the other.

## 9. Initial 30 Talents

### Common

#### T1001 - Sharp Eyes

*You notice details other people miss.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** INT +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks selected early-detection branches.

**Hooks:** channel none; family medical; investigation

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Straightforward useful Common; stronger than +1 to make low rarity still feel relevant.

#### T1002 - Knows Excel

*Your parents remain unsure whether this counts as a professional qualification.*

**Trigger:** threshold\_once    **Condition:** INT>=5

**Visible:** When INT >= 5: MNY +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors office/corporate ordinary events.

**Hooks:** channel ordinary; family corporate; finance

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Can trigger at start or years later after INT rises.

#### T1003 - Heavy Sleeper

*You can sleep through almost anything.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** SPR +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Suppresses some early overnight symptom-detection events and enables delayed variants.

**Hooks:** channel none; family medical; transformation\_symptom

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Visible benefit, hidden risk.

#### T1004 - Likes Pigeons

*They seem to like you too.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors parks/public-square events; unlocks rare monument epilogue interactions.

**Hooks:** channel ordinary; family civic; outdoor; memorial

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Apparently trivial talent with rare long-tail payoff.

## T1005 - Built Different

*Your physician dislikes this phrase.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** STR +3, INT -1

**Hidden / route mechanics:** None.

**Hooks:** channel none; family none

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Blunt, slightly stupid numeric comedy.

## T1006 - Bad Knees

*Standing for long periods has never been your specialty.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** STR -1

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors seated/supported Permanent Form variants where authored.

**Hooks:** channel none; family display; memorial

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Nominally negative but can redirect presentation outcomes.

## T1007 - Pretty Privilege

*Society has made several regrettable decisions in your favor.*

**Trigger:** threshold\_once    **Condition:** CHR>=8

**Visible:** When CHR >= 8: MNY +3

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors selected social and luxury-service branches.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family finance; luxury; social

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Explicit threshold talent; may trigger after CHR rises during life.

## T1008 - No Thoughts, Head Empty

*Life is considerably easier when you stop examining it.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** INT -2, SPR +4

**Hidden / route mechanics:** None.

**Hooks:** channel none; family none

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Mechanics deliver the joke rather than contradicting the text.

## T1009 - Frugal

*You can make three coins behave suspiciously like five.*

**Trigger:** threshold\_once    **Condition:** MNY<=3

**Visible:** When MNY <= 3: MNY +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors lower-cost branches in insurance, treatment, and preservation.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family finance; insurance; medical

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Can rescue a poor run without equating synthetic forms with cheapness.

## T1010 - Keeps a Low Profile

*You prefer not to become the center of attention.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** SPR +1

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Suppresses celebrity, political-symbol, and public-display families.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family celebrity; political\_symbol; display

**Incompatible:** T1023

**Design note:** Does not forbid public endings.

# Uncommon

## T1011 - Stoneworker's Daughter

*You knew the difference between granite and marble before long division.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors stone family; unlocks craft/restoration branches.

**Hooks:** channel transformation; family stone; craft; restoration

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Upbringing alters destiny across all species.

## T1012 - Perfect Posture

*People keep telling you to hold that pose.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** CHR +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors memorial, ceremonial, modeling, and standing display variants.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family memorial; ceremonial; display

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Clear benefit with visible long-term risk.

## T1013 - Property Lawyer

*You know exactly how disturbing the phrase "fixture attached to land" can become.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks legal branches involving self-ownership, liens, bankruptcy, inheritance, and attached-property disputes.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family legal; finance

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Automatic branches only; no player choice UI.

## T1014 - Corporate Favorite

*Management sees long-term potential in you.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** MNY +3, SPR -1

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors promotions and corporate-preservation chains.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family corporate

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Career success creates preservation exposure.

## T1015 - Second Opinion

*One doctor is an opinion. Two doctors are paperwork.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks alternative automatic branches when irreversible treatment is proposed.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family medical

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Provides alternative outcomes, not player options.

## T1016 - No Pain, No Gain

*Your body has filed several complaints. None were reviewed.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** STR +3, SPR -1

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Suppresses some early warning events; favors delayed severe variants.

**Hooks:** channel transformation; family symptom; medical

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Strong early benefit with delayed risk.

## T1017 - Late Bloomer

*Eventually everyone agrees you were merely taking your time.*

**Trigger:** threshold\_once    **Condition:** AGE>=35 & CHR<=5

**Visible:** When AGE >= 35 and CHR <= 5: CHR +4

**Hidden / route mechanics:** None.

**Hooks:** channel none; family none

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Demonstrates age-plus-stat threshold triggers.

## Rare

### T1018 - Museum Quality

*Curators use words like "preservation potential" around you.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** CHR +3

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Strongly favors museum/display routes, including acquisition and ownership disputes.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family museum; display; art

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Prestige is not autonomy.

### T1019 - Hard to Kill

*Death has repeatedly demonstrated poor follow-through.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Authored fatal events may redirect into emergency solidification, temporal suspension, or synthetic/medical preservation.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family medical; temporal; preservation

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Does not prevent permanent endings.

### T1020 - Old Soul

*Some places feel familiar before you have ever visited them.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks stronger AEVT/reincarnation-memory events.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family memory; reincarnation

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Cross-run depth without simultaneous selves.

## T1021 - Magnetic Personality

*People are drawn to you. Occasionally, so are metal objects.*

**Trigger:** start

**Visible:** CHR +2

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Favors metal transformation family and selected public/social events.

**Hooks:** channel transformation; family metal; social

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Literal mechanical pun.

## T1022 - Union Member

*Your employment contract is not the only contract in the room.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks labor/legal branches; suppresses some unilateral employer outcomes; favors arbitration/strike chains.

**Hooks:** channel institutional; family labor; legal; corporate

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Changes leverage, not whether workplace transformation can occur.

## T1023 - Main Character Syndrome

*Statistically improbable things keep happening near you.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Strongly favors Route/Special channel; reduces uneventful outcomes.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family rare; hidden

**Incompatible:** T1010

**Design note:** High variance rather than raw power.

# Legendary

## T1024 - My Body, My Property

*You have unusually strong opinions about the meaning of "self-ownership." The courts may eventually hear them.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Unlocks self-ownership/personhood branches after Permanent Form.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family legal; ownership

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Changes ending meaning, not transformation probability.



## T1025 - Unregistered Species

*According to several databases, you do not technically have a species.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Institutional events may treat species as unavailable while biological tendencies remain true species.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family bureaucracy; species\_registration

**Incompatible:** T1030

**Design note:** Classification anomaly without extra numeric meters.

## T1026 - Cheap Immortality

*Eternal preservation is surprisingly affordable if you stop asking questions.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Dangerous events may redirect into low-cost permanent preservation with legal/location/maintenance tradeoffs.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family preservation; finance; medical

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** Cheap describes service/route, not synthetic material as a category.

## T1027 - Hairline Fracture

*Something about you has been slightly wrong for as long as you can remember.*

**Trigger:** start\_hidden

**Visible:** No visible attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Raises starting FIX; unlocks fracture/restoration/anomalous-material routes and earlier transformation eligibility.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family fracture; restoration; anomaly

**Incompatible:** none

**Design note:** FIX effect remains completely hidden in UI.

# Anomalous

## T1028 - Object Permanence

*Changing the object does not necessarily change the person.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Where authored, consciousness continuity can survive carving, cracking, repair, recasting, relocation, or incorporation.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family identity; continuity

**Incompatible:** T1029

**Design note:** Creates unsettling epilogues, not invulnerability.

## T1029 - Soul Cannot Harden

*Your body may become permanent. Something else refuses to stay.*

**Trigger:** passive

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Where authored, consciousness need not remain permanently bound to the final object.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family identity; soul; reincarnation

**Incompatible:** T1028

**Design note:** Permanent body still exists.

## T1030 - Wrong Species Certificate

*Your biology and your paperwork disagree.*

**Trigger:** start\_hidden

**Visible:** No direct attribute modifier

**Hidden / route mechanics:** Assigns a different registeredSpecies while keeping true biological species for transformation tendencies.

**Hooks:** channel route\_special; family bureaucracy; species\_registration

**Incompatible:** T1025

**Design note:** Institutional branches may use registeredSpecies; biological tendencies use true species.

## 10. Machine-facing trigger semantics

| Trigger type   | Meaning                                                              |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| start          | Visible unconditional effect at run start.                           |
| start_hidden   | Hidden unconditional effect at run start.                            |
| threshold_once | Checked at trigger checkpoints until true; applies once permanently. |
| passive        | Persistent event drafting / eligibility / branch modifier.           |

## 11. Cross-system requirements

- Talents may operate at channel, family, or individual event/branch level.
- No mid-life player choice UI is introduced by a talent. Alternative 'options' mean automatic branches.
- Hairline Fracture keeps its FIX increase completely hidden from the player.
- Event content must preserve substantial visible-stat movement throughout life.
- If Monte Carlo testing shows threshold talents rarely trigger after age 18, increase event-driven attribute movement before weakening threshold conditions.
- Common talents must remain available at high reincarnation counts.

## 12. Handoff rule

ChatGPT owns talent concepts, prose, gameplay intent, threshold conditions, interactions, and localization. Coding agents own schemas, trigger evaluation, event checks, validators, tests, and data import. Coding agents must not rewrite approved prose or invent substitute mechanics unless a documented contradiction prevents implementation.